Renewal 2027 – Lumen IPP

Monday, 26 October 2026 09:12

Key dates

- Agreement ends: **31 March 2027**
- Draft proposal to Rainer: **11 Dec**
- Rainer needs final: mid-January
- Executive Board: **4 Feb 2027** (Aigner chairs for research items)
- Prepayment top-up decision: before Jan (balance EUR 18,450 on 27 Oct, lasts to ~mid-Dec)

What Rainer wants (his words)

- "One page." Same format as the DEAL memo last year → cost / without agreement / compliance
- "No method, no trust." Every figure needs a source he can explain
- Aigner asks about OA policy + DFG, not Altmetric

Lumen figures (Tobias, 27 Oct, Jan–Sep 2026)

Item	Lumen says	My check
Articles	138	Our fund records: 141 (3 not yet invoiced?)
List price total	EUR 338,100	Which list price? 2026 or at submission?
Paid	EUR 287,040	Matches prepayment statements ✓
Saved	EUR 51,060	Only vs. their list price
Avg paid APC	EUR 2,080	OpenAPC avg for Lumen 2025: ~EUR 2,190 → plausible
Funder compliance	93%	How do they define "compliant"? Ask
Reviewers / editors	27	No names. Need them!

Last time (2024) – what worked, what didn't

- 2 full days copying from 6 portals into the Excel. Never again.
- First draft 4 pages → Rainer: "too long". Rewrote overnight.
- **What tipped it:** Ana Ferreira = guest editor at Lumen. Nobody on the Board knew. Aigner asked "who else?"
- Altmetric charts: nobody looked at them. Leave out or one line max.

Ideas

- Ask Lumen for the names of the 27 (with consent!) → one line "Our people at Lumen"
- Cost per article vs. OpenAPC average = the independent comparison Rainer wants
- Compliance: map their 93% to our OA policy (CC BY, immediate OA, data availability statement)
- Why can't Lumen just send this as a PDF 90 days before expiry? Every year the same scramble.

Call with Tobias Frei (Lumen)

Wednesday, 28 October 2026 14:00 · Teams, 25 min

- He builds renewal reports by hand, ~5 h per institution; he has 52. Explains why it comes so late.
- List price = APC list price **at acceptance** (not today's). OK, note that in the method line.
- Funder compliance = CC BY + deposit in PMC/Europe PMC where required + funder named in acknowledgements. Does not check our data policy.
- Names of reviewers/editors: possible, but they need consent from each person → he'll ask internally.
- Formatted report: "early December". Too late for my draft on 11 Dec, realistically.
- He mentioned a "partner dashboard" in Manuscripta. I said I log in maybe 3× a year, when the prepayment runs low. He laughed – apparently that's normal.

☑ Send Rainer the Q3 figures (done 27 Oct)
☐ Cross-check 138 vs. 141 articles with Lukas
☐ Ask Ana Ferreira, K. Lindner, T. Okafor if we may name them
☐ OpenAPC comparison for all 11 publishers (cost per article)
☐ Chase the two missing portal exports
☐ Draft 1-pager by 11 Dec

Questions I still can't answer

- What would we pay *without* the agreement? Full list price, or would authors go elsewhere?
- Is a bigger prepayment worth it? Rainer would top up "if demand rises and the budget stays predictable".
- Do the other 10 publishers give me anything comparable? (Short answer: no.)